

Title

Brief Educational Intervention and Screening Initiation in Young Adults With Type 2 Diabetes: Four-Week Outcomes From a Pragmatic Trial

Abstract

Low screening participation for diabetic retinopathy in younger patients represents a preventable risk gap. We randomized 129 participants (mean age 28 years, 42% male) with type 2 diabetes, of whom 34 (26%) had never undergone retinal screening. Among the 34 unscreened participants, we aimed to evaluate whether provision of a tailored educational leaflet would increase subsequent screening initiation compared with standard practice. Of the originally enrolled participants, 101 completed follow-up at 4 weeks. In the unscreened subgroup, screening initiation rates showed a non-significant trend favoring the education group (38% vs. 24%; $p=0.28$), though statistical power was limited by lower-than-expected enrollment in this subgroup. Among all 101 participants completing follow-up, the intervention group demonstrated significantly greater increases in factual knowledge about retinopathy (mean gain 2.8 points vs. 1.1 points; $p=0.03$, $\eta^2=0.05$). Attrition was associated with participant demographic factors including place of birth and primary language.